The Twelve Names of the Goddess Śrī

Śrīdevīdvādaśanāma · Toh 1006 · Derge Kangyur
དཔལ་གྱི་ལྷ་མོའི་མཚན་བཅུ་གཉིས་པ།

The Twelve Names of the Goddess Śrī, known in Tibetan as Pal gyi Lhamo'i Tsen Chunyipa, is a short scripture devoted to Śrī, or Lakṣmī, the great goddess of fortune and prosperity. It opens in the realm of Sukhāvatī, where the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara and the great goddess Śrī, herself honored here as a bodhisattva and great being, come before the Blessed One. The Buddha then turns to Avalokiteśvara to teach the benefits that will come to monks, nuns, lay followers, or any being who keeps and recites the goddess's twelve names, which are held to bring good fortune and remove poverty and misfortune. The text is Toh 1006 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts, the collection of brief scriptures centered on sacred formulas and recitations.

The Twelve Names of the Goddess Śrī (Lakṣmī).

Homage to the Three Jewels!
Homage to the noble Avalokiteśvara!
Homage to Vajrapāṇi!
Homage to the great goddess Śrī!

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling in the world of Sukhāvatī. Then the bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara, went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, the great goddess Śrī also went to where the Blessed One was. Having come into his presence, she bowed her head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side.

Then the Blessed One looked at Mahāśrī and spoke these words to Avalokiteśvara: "Avalokiteśvara, if any monk or nun, layman or laywoman, or any sentient being whatsoever knows these twelve names of Mahāśrī, and keeps them, reads them, practices them, and recites them, that person will be rid of poverty and become very wealthy."

Then all the hosts of bhūtas also said, "May it be so!"

The twelve names of the great goddess Śrī are these: Auspicious One, Glorious One, Bearer of the Lotus Garland, Mistress of Wealth, White-Skirted One,

Greatly Renowned One, Lotus-Eyed One, Renowned One, Great Radiance, Giver of Food, Endowed with Jewel Light, and Great Śrī.

Homage to all the buddhas!
Homage to Avalokiteśvara!
Homage to Mahāśrī!

It is like this: jini ghriṇi, you who accomplish all needs, simi simi nimi nimi, dispel all my ignorance! svāhā

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara rejoiced at what the Blessed One had said.

The Twelve Names of the Great Goddess Śrī is complete.

It was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptor Jinamitra and the chief editor and translator, the venerable Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

• The twelve names are given in English translation because their exact Sanskrit originals cannot be reconstructed with confidence. "White-Skirted One" renders a Tibetan epithet whose precise Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain. Where the Tibetan has "It is like this," it renders the Sanskrit tadyathā, which introduces the dhāraṇī. The Blessed One dwelling in Sukhāvatī is presumably Amitābha, but the text does not name him.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.